

sometimes the second baby is monitored in this way and the first baby may have a scalp electrode put on his head (see [Scalp electrode](#)), which gives a clearer picture of the first baby's heartbeat if it has been difficult to find.

Delivering the first twin For your first baby, the chance of using forceps or vacuum is the same as for a singleton birth, although the birth of the first twin may need to be assisted so that the doctor can gain quick access to the second twin. After the first twin's delivery, the cord is clamped and cut, but the placenta usually remains in the uterus until the second baby has been born.

Delivering the second twin The medical team will confirm how the second baby is positioned. As the second baby's head or bottom enters the pelvis, the second sac of water may be broken to encourage strong contractions. A normal birth should follow in about 30 minutes, and forceps or vacuum are used only if problems arise. If the second twin is bottom-first, a doctor should be on hand to help. It's unusual for the first twin to be born vaginally and the second to be born by a cesarean, but this may happen if the second baby needs an urgent delivery and a vaginal birth seems unsafe.

Delivering the placenta There is a greater risk of postpartum hemorrhage with twins, which means that an active management of [the third stage](#) may be advised.



With a twin delivery a larger medical team will be on hand to deal with any complications and to take care of both babies at birth.

BIRTH STORY: A TWIN BIRTH
